CASE ANALYSIS REPORT

CupTime - Tea and Coffee Delivery

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1. ENTREPRENEUR – 1

Name of the Entrepreneur: Prabhaharan Venugopal

Company: Cup Time

Location: Madurai, Tamil Nadu

Industry: Food & Beverage Startup

Entrepreneur Profile

Prabhaharan Venugopal is the founder of Cup Time, a small beverage startup located in Madurai, Tamil Nadu. He comes from a technical and professional background, but instead of pursuing a career in the engineering or aviation sector, he decided to explore entrepreneurship in a completely different field. His interest in starting a business was driven by the desire to create a service that could solve everyday problems faced by working professionals. With this idea in mind, he established Cup Time, a small yet innovative beverage startup that focuses on providing quick and affordable tea and coffee services.

The main objective behind starting Cup Time was to make it easier for people, especially office employees and shop workers, to access fresh beverages without wasting time. In busy urban areas like Madurai, many employees depend on nearby tea stalls for their short breaks during work hours. However, they often have to walk out of their offices, wait in queues, and spend valuable time just to get a cup of tea or coffee. Prabhaharan Venugopal carefully observed this common problem faced by workers in offices and commercial areas. He realized that a simple but well-organized beverage service could make a big difference in saving time and improving convenience.Based on this observation, he started Cup Time with the vision of creating a small business that provides fast service, quality beverages, and pleasant customer experience.

1.1 PART A – INTERVIEW SCHEDULE

Interview conducted by: Maha Shree B, Mahalakshmi B
Interviewee: Prabhaharan Venugopal
Company: Cup Time
Location: Madurai, Tamil Nadu

As part of this case study, an interview was conducted with Mr. Prabhaharan Venugopal, the founder of Cup Time, to understand his entrepreneurial journey and the growth of the business. The following questions were asked during the interview.

Q1: What inspired you to start Cup Time?
Answer: I observed that many office workers needed quick access to tea and coffee during work hours. This inspired me to start a small beverage business that provides fast and convenient service.
Q2: Why did you choose the food and beverage sector instead of engineering?
Answer: I wanted to try something different from my academic field. The food and beverage sector has constant demand, which made it a good business opportunity.
Q3: What challenges did you face when starting the business?
Answer: The initial challenges included arranging capital, selecting a suitable location, and attracting customers during the early stage.
Q4: How did you promote your business in the beginning?
Answer: The business was mainly promoted through word of mouth, social media, and by providing good service to customers.
Q5: What are the main products offered at Cup Time?
Answer: We mainly provide tea, coffee, and light snacks that customers can enjoy during short breaks.

Q6: Who are your main customers?

Answer: Most of our customers are office employees, students, and people working in nearby shops and businesses.

Q7: What makes Cup Time different from other tea shops?

Answer: We focus on cleanliness, quick service, and maintaining the quality and taste of our beverages.

Q8: How do you ensure customer satisfaction?

Answer: We ensure that beverages are prepared fresh, maintain hygiene, and provide friendly service to customers.

Q9: What are your future plans for the business?

Answer: My future plan is to expand the business and possibly open more outlets in different parts of the city.

Q10: What advice would you give to students who want to become entrepreneurs?

Answer: Start with a simple idea, understand customer needs, and work consistently to improve your business.

Q11: How did you arrange the initial investment for starting the business?

Answer: The initial investment was arranged through personal savings and support from family members.

Q12: What factors helped your business grow in the local market?

Answer: Good product quality, reasonable pricing, and positive feedback from customers helped the business grow.

Q13: How do you maintain the quality of tea and coffee?

Answer: We use good quality ingredients and prepare the beverages fresh every day to maintain taste and quality.

Q14: What skills are important for running a small business like this?

Answer: Good communication, patience, financial management, and customer service skills are very important.

1.2 PART B (I) – COMPANY ANALYSIS

Products and Services

Cup Time mainly provides beverages and light refreshments to customers. The main products offered by the shop include tea, coffee, snacks, and other light refreshments. These products are prepared fresh and served at affordable prices. Tea and coffee are the most popular items, and they attract customers such as office employees, students, and local residents who want quick refreshments during their breaks.

Strengths

One of the major strengths of Cup Time is its quick service. Customers can easily get their beverages without waiting for a long time. Another important strength is the affordable pricing of the products, which makes the shop accessible to a wide range of customers. In addition, the location of the shop near offices and busy areas helps attract regular customers throughout the day.

Weaknesses

Cup Time operates on a small scale, which can limit its production and service capacity. The seating space available in the shop is also limited, which may restrict the number of customers who can stay and enjoy refreshments. These factors may affect the growth of the business if customer demand increases significantly.

Opportunities

There are several opportunities for the growth of Cup Time. The owner can expand the business by opening more outlets in other parts of the city. Another opportunity is introducing online ordering and delivery services, which can help reach more customers and increase sales.

Threats

The business faces competition from other tea shops and beverage outlets in the nearby area. These competitors may attract customers by offering similar products.

1.3 PART B (II) – BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

The Business Model Canvas explains how a business creates value for its customers and how it earns revenue. It includes important components such as key partners, key activities, value proposition, customer segments, channels, and revenue streams. For the company Cup Time, the business model mainly focuses on providing quick and affordable beverages while maintaining quality and customer satisfaction.

Key partners

Key partners are the people or organizations that support the business in running its operations. Cup Time depends on milk suppliers who provide fresh milk regularly for preparing tea and coffee. Tea and coffee powder suppliers are also important partners because they ensure good taste and quality.

Key activities

Key activities are the important tasks required to operate the business. The main activity of Cup Time is preparing fresh tea and coffee for customers throughout the day. Customer service is another important activity, which includes taking orders and interacting with customers in a friendly manner. Sales and marketing activities also help the business attract new customers and increase awareness about the shop.

Value proposition

The value proposition describes what makes the business special for customers. Cup Time focuses on providing fresh, affordable, and quickly prepared beverages. The business ensures good taste, hygiene, and quick service so that customers can enjoy their drinks without long waiting times.

Customer segments

Customer segments include the groups of people who purchase products from the shop. The main customers of Cup Time are office employees, students, and local residents who want quick refreshments during their breaks.

1.4 CASELETS

Caselet 1 – Identifying a Business Opportunity

One of the most important aspects of entrepreneurship is identifying opportunities in everyday life. The founder of Cup Time observed that many office employees and workers in busy areas of Madurai faced difficulty in getting quick refreshments during their short breaks. Most people had to walk long distances or wait in crowded tea stalls to get a cup of tea or coffee.

Recognizing this problem, the entrepreneur saw an opportunity to start a business that could provide quick and convenient beverage services. By focusing on speed, affordability, and quality, Cup Time was able to attract many customers. This caselet highlights how observing common problems in society can lead to successful business ideas.

The lesson from this caselet is that entrepreneurs must carefully observe their surroundings and identify unmet customer needs. A simple solution to a common problem can become a successful business venture.

Caselet 2 – Importance of Customer Satisfaction

Customer satisfaction plays a crucial role in the success of any business. In the case of Cup Time, the entrepreneur focused on maintaining good quality tea and coffee, cleanliness, and friendly customer service. These factors helped the business gain positive feedback from customers.

When customers receive good service and quality products, they are more likely to return to the same shop and recommend it to others. Word-of-mouth promotion is especially important for small businesses because it helps attract new customers without spending much on advertising.

This caselet shows that maintaining product quality and good customer relationships are key factors for business growth and long-term success.

Caselet 3 – Challenges Faced by Small Entrepreneurs

Starting and managing a small business involves several challenges. In the early stages of Cup Time, the entrepreneur faced difficulties such as arranging initial capital, selecting the right location, and attracting customers. These challenges are common for many startups.

Another challenge faced by small businesses is competition from other shops that offer similar products. To overcome these challenges, the entrepreneur focused on maintaining quality, offering reasonable prices, and providing quick service.

This caselet demonstrates that perseverance, planning, and continuous improvement are necessary for entrepreneurs to overcome obstacles and sustain their businesses.

Caselet 4 – Innovation and Business Growth

Innovation plays an important role in the growth and sustainability of a business. Entrepreneurs must constantly look for ways to improve their products and services to stay competitive in the market. In the case of Cup Time, the entrepreneur introduced small improvements such as offering different varieties of tea and coffee, maintaining hygiene, and ensuring quick service for customers.

By observing customer preferences, the entrepreneur can introduce new menu items such as flavored tea, special coffee, or light snacks. These small innovations can help attract new customers and also retain existing ones. Innovation does not always require large investments; even simple ideas and improvements can make a significant difference.

This caselet highlights that entrepreneurs should always be open to new ideas and continuously adapt their business according to customer needs and market trends. Continuous improvement and innovation help businesses remain relevant and achieve long-term success.

2. CONCLUSION

The case study of Cup Time provides a clear example of how a small entrepreneurial idea can develop into a successful local business. By understanding customer needs and offering convenient beverage services, the entrepreneur was able to create a business that attracts regular customers.

The study also shows that entrepreneurship requires dedication, observation of market needs, and continuous improvement. Small businesses like Cup Time contribute to the local economy by providing services and creating employment opportunities.

Furthermore, the case study highlights the importance of identifying opportunities in everyday situations and converting them into successful business ideas. Entrepreneurs must be willing to take risks and show dedication to achieve their goals. Proper planning, effective management, and understanding customer needs are essential factors for business success. Small businesses like Cup Time demonstrate how simple ideas can grow into sustainable ventures with consistent effort.

The entrepreneur's focus on quality, affordability, and customer satisfaction has played a key role in the success of the business. This study also emphasizes the importance of innovation and continuous improvement in maintaining competitiveness. Entrepreneurs must adapt to changing market trends and customer preferences to ensure long-term growth. The case study also inspires students and aspiring entrepreneurs to explore new business opportunities. With determination, creativity, and hard work, anyone can start and develop a successful business. Overall, the journey of Cup Time serves as a motivation for future entrepreneurs to pursue their ideas with confidence.

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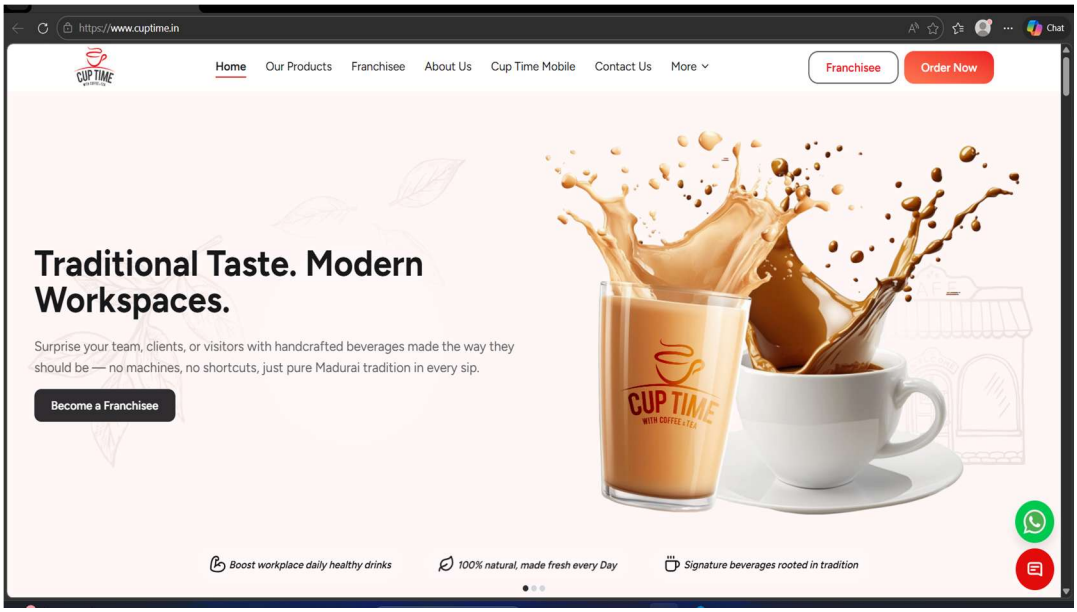

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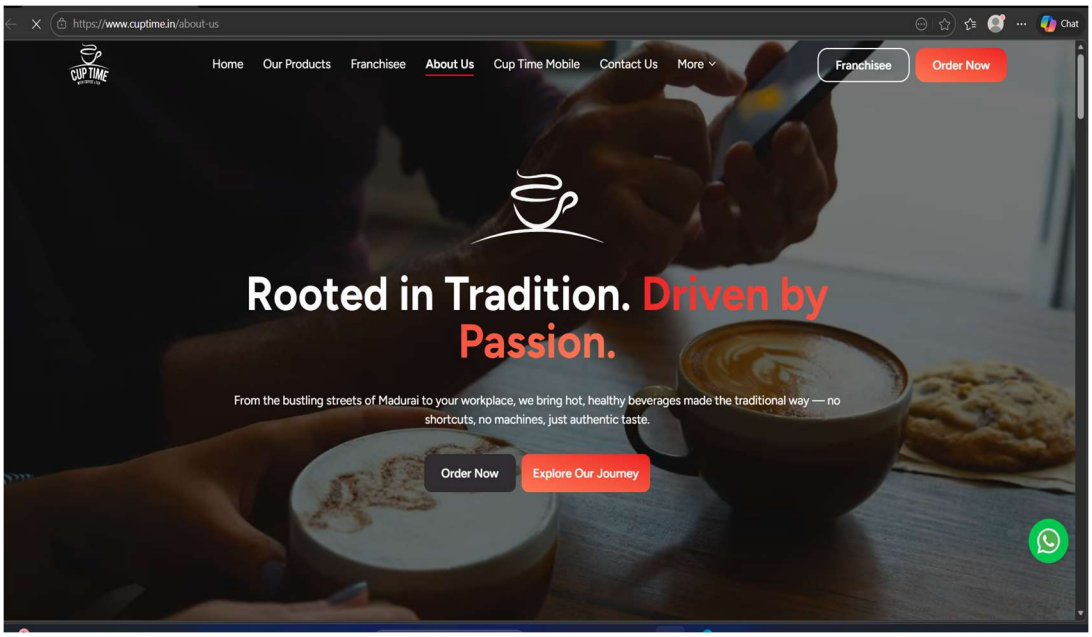

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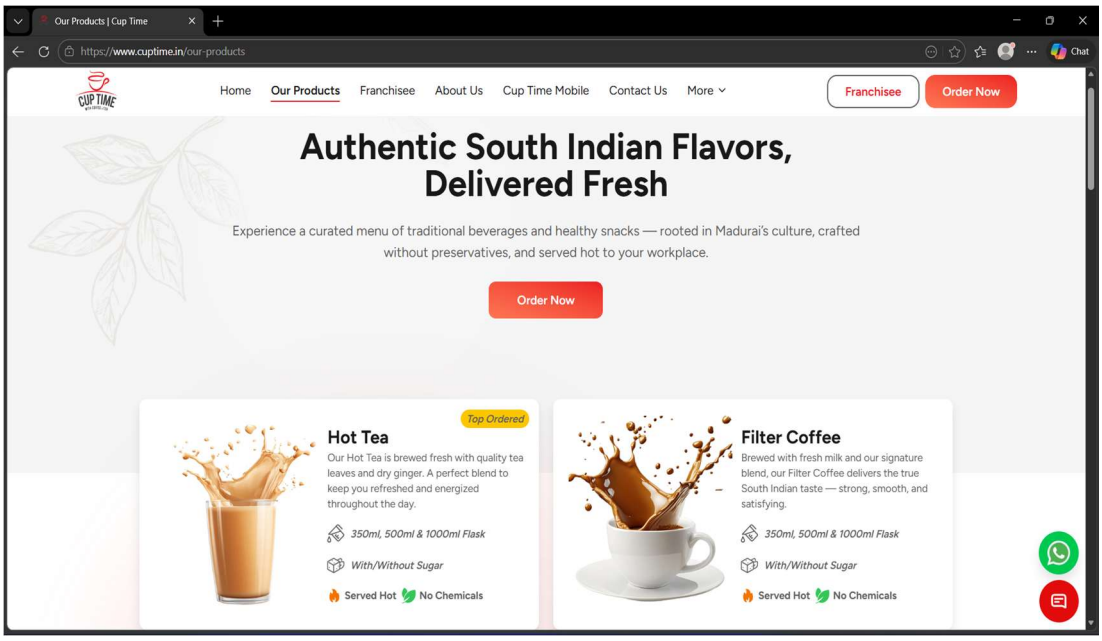

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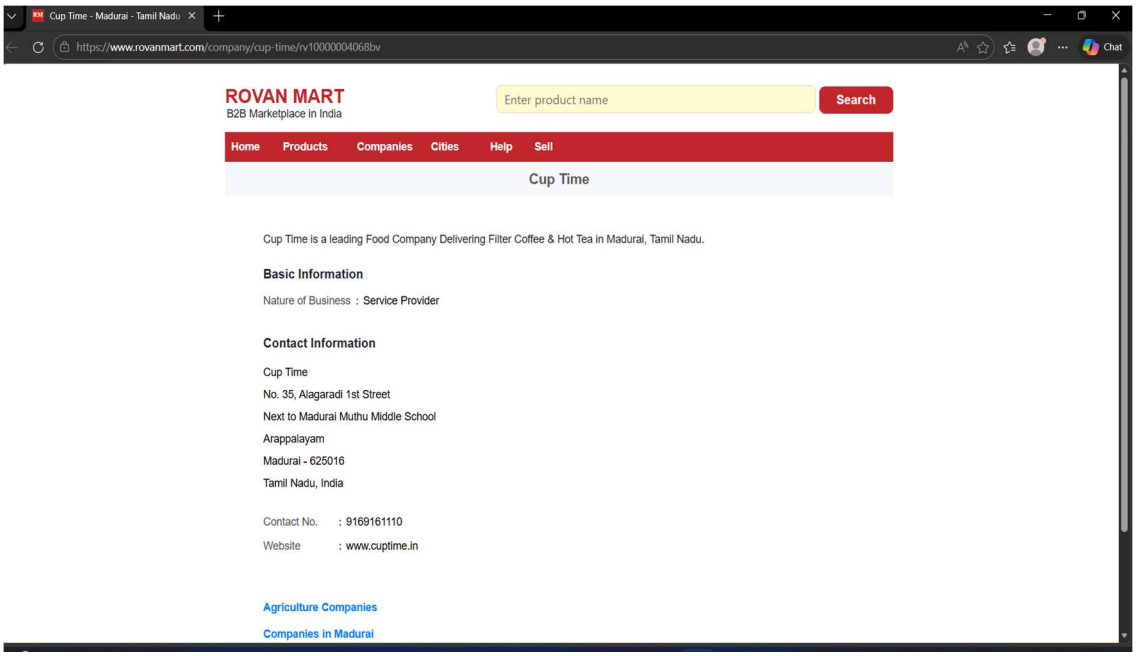

4. ANNEXURES

4.1 Shipping Company

4.2 Milk Processing and Filtration at Cup Time Production Unit

4.3 Large-Scale Milk Heating and Preparation Unit – Cup Time

4.4Storage and Transportation of Tea and Coffee Flasks – Cup Time Distribution Process